

Lesson 01

Opening A Meeting



Warm-Up

1. What are some effective ways to start a meeting?
2. What are some common mistakes to avoid in starting a meeting?





Role-Play

Scenario: *Project Manager, Alden, is having a kick-off meeting for the new project with his two team members, Kath and Daniel.*

Alden: All right, **let's get started**. Good morning, everyone. Welcome to the kick-off meeting for our new project.

Kath: Good morning, Alden.

Alden: **The aim of this meeting is** to review the project objectives, timeline, and roles and responsibilities. We'll also discuss our communication plan and expectations.

Daniel: Sounds like **we've got a lot to cover**.

Alden: Yes, we do. But **first, let's go over** the review of the project objectives. (shares presentation, followed by timeline and roles and responsibilities.)

Kath and Daniel: Looks good and clear.

Alde: Great. Now, let's discuss our communication plan. We'll be having regular team meetings, and I encourage everyone to speak up and share their thoughts and ideas.

Kath: Sounds good.

Alden: Alright, **that's all for today**. Let's get started on this project!

Role-Play Analysis

Answer the following questions:

1. What did Alden say to get everyone's attention?
2. What is the purpose of the meeting?
3. What did Alden say in reviewing the project summary?
4. How do you start meetings in your company?



Useful Phrases in Opening a Meeting

1. **The aim/purpose of today's meeting is...** – used to clearly state the meeting's purpose and establish expectations for the meeting outcomes.

Example:

- ***The aim/purpose of this meeting is** to discuss the current project status, address any challenges, and outline the next steps.*

2. **First, let's go over... / Before we begin...** – used in reviewing the agenda, discussing objectives, or reviewing previous meeting.

Example:

- ***First, let's go over** the agenda for today's meeting to ensure we cover all the necessary topics.*
- ***Before we begin,** I'd like to review the agenda for today's meeting to ensure we cover all necessary topics.*

3. **Let's get started** – used to signal the beginning of the meeting and encourage attendees to focus and engage.

Example:

- *Now that we have everyone here, **let's get started.** Our first topic is...*



Practice 1

Instructions: Guess the meeting type based on the meeting description. Choose your answer in the box.

Progress Meeting	Brainstorming Session	Decision-Making Meeting
Planning Meeting	Status Update Meeting	

1. We'll be discussing the current project status, addressing any challenges, and setting goals for the next quarter.
2. We'll be generating new ideas for our marketing campaign and exploring innovative approaches to reach our target audience.
3. We'll be reviewing the company's financial performance, discussing budget allocations, and making strategic for the upcoming year.
4. We'll review the project scope, timeline, and budget, and work together to assign tasks and responsibilities.
5. We'll review the current progress, discuss any challenges or obstacles, and provide updated un upcoming milestones.

Discussion Point:

- What are the characteristics of each meeting type?



Practice 2

Instructions:

Team up with a partner and start a typical meeting. Capture everyone's attention and apply effective words and phrases to set the tone for the discussion. Make sure to engage participants and establish a welcoming atmosphere for discussion.

Tips:

By having clear purpose and objectives, concise agenda review, establishing expectations, and encouraging engagement into your meeting opening, you can set the stage for a productive, efficient, and effective meeting.



Production

Be more confident in opening a meeting by answering the following questions.

1. How can you ensure that all attendees are aware of the meeting's purpose or agenda?
2. How can you ensure that all attendees are engaged and focus from the beginning?
3. How can you ensure that all attendees understand their roles and responsibilities during the meeting?
4. How can you create a safe and respectful environment for open discussion?
5. How can you keep a meeting on track and ensure that all topics were covered?



Key Vocabulary

Word/Phrase	Use	Example
Kick-off	Used to signal the start of a new project or initiative	Good morning, everyone. Welcome to the kick-off meeting for our new project.
Outline	Used in providing a clear structure for the meeting	To ensure we cover all necessary topics, let me outline the agenda for today's meeting.
Welcome	Used to create a positive and friendly tone	Hey team, welcome to our meeting today. Let's get started.
Set objectives	Used to establish clear goals and expectations and to ensure that everyone is on the same page	Hello, team. To ensure we're all on the same page, let's set our objectives for this project.
Go over	Used to review and clarify valuable information	Let's go over the key takeaways from our last meeting to ensure we're building on our previous discussions.